K8s-autoscaler version incompatibility on berkeley-geoupyter cluster

Status: Reviewed

Overview

The cluster was running an older k8s version than the majority of clusters. Once the cluster autoscaler version was bumped a day prior, the two became incompatible.

What Happened

New nodes were not being spawned because the cluster autoscaler wasn't triggering scale-up events.

Resolution

Upgrading the k8s version of the cluster from 1.33 to 1.34 and downgrading the cluster autoscaler, one patch version, fixed it.

Where we got lucky

The problem was triggered by an automatic health check run and not by actual users not being able to spawn servers.

What Went Well?

Context about the cluster autoscaler version bump was fresh, so we went on the correct path from the beginning.

What Didn't Go So Well?

When we designed the upgrade batches, we only took into account clusters running 1.32, so this 1.33 cluster was missed.

Action Items

- https://github.com/2i2c-org/infrastructure/pull/8008
- Recurrent issues like https://github.com/2i2c-org/infrastructure/blob/main/.github/workflows/recurrent-k8s-aws-upgrades.yaml should help standardize versions across clusters

OWNER OF REVIEW PROCESS

Georgiana

IMPACT TIME

Mar 31 at 15:10 to Mar 31 at 17:00

DURATION

1h 49m 10s

*All times listed in this report are in Bucharest.

Timeline

Mar 31, 2026

3:10 PM

Triggered through the API.
Description: [FIRING:1] At least two servers failed to start in the last 30m cluster=berkeley-geojupyter hub=prod (provider=aws immediate action needed) (View Message)

INCIDENT #2057

[FIRING:1] At least two servers failed to start in the last 30m cluster=berkeley-geojupyter hub=prod (provider=aws immediate action needed)

3:16 PM

Angus Hollands #server_start_inc_2057

I'm not seeing a scale-up event here. Checking the node group labels, etc. now.

3:23 PM

Georgiana Dolocan #server_start_inc_2057

why is this cluster even running 1.33? :thinking_face:

3:35 PM

Angus Hollands #server_start_inc_2057

I don't think the autoscaler is behaving properly. I am now looking at the autoscaler deployment logs.

3:37 PM

Georgiana Dolocan #server_start_inc_2057

Ah... it might have something to do with the upgrade? I think the autoscaler version got bumped too in the upgrade I merged yesterday

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3:41 PM

Georgiana Dolocan #server_start_inc_2057

yes, let's upgrade to 1.34

4:34 PM

Georgiana Dolocan #server_start_inc_2057

and will then downgrade the autoscaler version to 9.55.0 which is meant for k8s 1.34

4:48 PM

Georgiana Dolocan #server_start_inc_2057

ok, this fixed it.

4:48 PM

Georgiana Dolocan #server_start_inc_2057

outage is resolved
